

# Five checks a COO or CFO can run this week.

No technical knowledge required. Each check takes minutes, and each one surfaces the same underlying question: does anyone own this outcome, or only fragments of it? Answers that start with “I think...” are the findings.

## 01 Name the owner of each area — from memory.

Support, security, Microsoft 365, devices, networks, vendors. For each: who is the single accountable owner? Not “the MSP” — a name. If two leaders in the room give different answers, that area is unowned.

FINDING: AREAS WITH ZERO OR TWO OWNERS

## 02 Pull the last five “resolved” tickets.

For each one, ask: was the cause fixed, or the symptom cleared? A password reset is a symptom; asking why lockouts spiked is a cause. Five symptoms in a row means your provider runs a queue, not an operation.

FINDING: RECURRING ISSUES WITH NO ROOT-CAUSE TASK

## 03 Time your last onboarding.

How many days from start date until the new hire had laptop, accounts, and correct access — fully, without follow-ups? Ask HR and the hiring manager separately. The gap between their answers is the process.

FINDING: NO SINGLE OWNER OF “READY ON DAY ONE”

## 04 Ask for the renewal calendar.

Licenses, hardware refresh, contracts, domains, certificates. Does a single forward-looking calendar exist — or do renewals surprise finance? If it does not exist, next year's surprises are already scheduled.

FINDING: RENEWALS DISCOVERED AT INVOICE TIME

## 05 Ask what happened to the last security alert.

Who saw it, who investigated, who decided, and where is that written down? Then one more: when was a backup last restored — actually restored, not “the job ran.” Both answers should be specific and boring.

FINDING: ALERTS AND BACKUPS NOBODY OWNS

### Scoring

**5 clean answers:** your IT has real ownership — rare and worth protecting. **3–4:** typical for a growing company; the gaps are fixable with standards and a named owner per area. **0–2:** your next incident is already in motion; ownership, not tooling, is the fix.

